

HOUSE RESOLUTION 149

By Garrett

A RESOLUTION to condemn the failure of Nashville Electric Service during the recent storm event and call upon the board of directors of Nashville Electric Service to exercise leadership, including the replacement of the chief executive officer.

WHEREAS, Nashville Electric Service (NES) is entrusted with the critical responsibility of providing reliable electric service to the residents, businesses, hospitals, and first responders of Davidson County and parts of Sumner, Rutherford, Robertson, Williamson, Wilson, and Cheatham counties; and

WHEREAS, severe storm events are foreseeable and recurring in Middle Tennessee, and electric utilities have a duty to prepare, respond, and communicate effectively during such emergencies; and

WHEREAS, during the recent storm impacting Nashville and the surrounding region, NES experienced widespread outages affecting tens of thousands of customers, including prolonged outages lasting days in some neighborhoods; and

WHEREAS, numerous constituents reported a lack of timely restoration, inadequate communication, inaccurate outage estimates, and insufficient transparency from NES leadership throughout the crisis; and

WHEREAS, these failures compounded the hardship faced by families, seniors, medically vulnerable residents, and local businesses already dealing with storm damage; and

WHEREAS, confidence in a public utility depends not only on infrastructure but on competent leadership, accountability, and honest communication; and

WHEREAS, the response by NES leadership has raised serious concerns regarding preparedness, management effectiveness, and executive decision-making; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we formally condemn the abysmal response of Nashville Electric Service to the recent storm event and find that such performance falls short of the standard expected of a critical public utility.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we call upon the Board of Directors of Nashville Electric Service to conduct a full and transparent review of the storm response, including operational readiness, communication failures, and leadership performance.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we hereby urge the NES Board of Directors to exercise its authority to replace the chief executive officer should the board determine that current leadership is unwilling or unable to restore public confidence and ensure reliable service going forward.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we call for NES to present a comprehensive corrective action plan addressing storm preparedness, grid hardening, workforce deployment, and customer communication, with measurable benchmarks and public reporting.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that a certified copy of this resolution be transmitted to the Board of Directors of Nashville Electric Service, the Mayor of the Metropolitan Government of Nashville and Davidson County, and the members of the Metropolitan Council of Nashville and Davidson County.